

Mastering keyboard shortcuts is the fastest way to boost your productivity in Excel, especially when managing complex datasets or large-scale **AI and Data Science** projects.

1. Essential Navigation & Selection

These shortcuts help you move quickly across the **1,048,576 rows** in an Excel worksheet.

- **Ctrl + Arrow Keys:** Jump to the last non-empty cell in the direction of the arrow.
 - **Ctrl + Shift + Arrow Keys:** Select all cells from the current position to the last non-empty cell.
 - **Ctrl + Home:** Jump to cell **A1**.
 - **Ctrl + End:** Jump to the last used cell in the worksheet.
 - **Ctrl + G:** Open the "Go To" dialog box (useful for jumping to **Defined Names**).
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2. Data Entry & Editing

Use these to speed up manual data entry for project trackers or student records.

- **F2:** Edit the active cell.
 - **Ctrl + D:** "Fill Down" — copies the content and formatting of the top cell in a selection into the cells below.
 - **Ctrl + R:** "Fill Right" — copies the content and formatting of the leftmost cell into the cells to the right.
 - **Ctrl + ; (Semicolon):** Insert the current date.
 - **Ctrl + Shift + : (Colon):** Insert the current time.
 - **Alt + Enter:** Start a new line within the same cell.
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3. Formatting Shortcuts

Formatting is key for professional **Data Visualization** and clear **Salary statements**.

- **Ctrl + 1:** Open the **Format Cells** dialog box.
 - **Ctrl + Shift + ~:** Apply the **General** number format.
 - **Ctrl + Shift + \$:** Apply the **Currency** format.
 - **Ctrl + Shift + %:** Apply the **Percentage** format.
 - **Ctrl + B / Ctrl + I:** Toggle **Bold** or *Italics*.
 - **Alt + H, B, A:** Apply "All Borders" to a selection (sequential keys).
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4. Formulas and Functions

Essential for auditing and building calculations.

- **Alt + =**: Automatically insert the **SUM** function (AutoSum).
- **Ctrl + ` (Grave Accent)**: Toggle between showing cell values and cell formulas.
- **F4**: While editing a formula, cycles through absolute and relative references (e.g., changing A1 to \$A\$1).
- **Ctrl + Shift + Enter**: The legacy method to enter an array formula (not needed for modern **Dynamic Array Functions**).

5. Workbook and Sheet Management

- **Ctrl + N**: Create a new workbook.
- **Ctrl + Page Up / Page Down**: Switch between worksheet tabs.
- **Alt + H, I, S**: Insert a new worksheet.
- **Ctrl + S**: Save the workbook (remember to save as **.xlsm** if you are using **VBA**).
- **Alt + F11**: Open the **Visual Basic Editor**.

6. Table and Filter Shortcuts

- **Ctrl + T**: Convert a selected range into an official **Excel Table**.
- **Ctrl + Shift + L**: Toggle **AutoFilter** on or off.
- **Alt + Down Arrow**: Open the filter dropdown menu for the current column.